IlmForge

Staff user manual

For **office staff, accountants, teachers and principals** using IlmForge day to day. No technical knowledge is assumed. Every instruction names the exact button you will see on screen. Part 1 is done once, in order, before the school can run. The rest are daily tasks.

Part 1 · Do this once, in order

First-time setup

The order matters. You cannot admit a student before classes exist, and you cannot generate fees before a fee structure exists. Doing it out of order is the most common cause of "the system won't let me" during training.

Step 1 · School profile

Sidebar › School Settings

1. Fill in **School Identity** with the school name, then **Upload Logo**.
2. Fill in **Contact Details**: address, phone, email.
3. Click **Save Profile**.

NOTE

The logo and name you set here appear on ID cards, fee vouchers, admission forms, result cards and the login page your staff and parents see. Set it properly once.

Step 2 · Academic session

Sidebar › School Settings › Academic Sessions `/settings/sessions`

1. Click **Add Session**.
2. Enter the session, for example `2025-2026`, with its start and end dates.
3. Save. The active session shows in the top bar of every page.

Step 3 · Classes and sections

Sidebar › **School Settings** › **Classes** `/settings/classes`

1. Under **Add Class**, type the class name (Nursery, KG, Class 1 … Matric) and click **Add Class**.
2. Repeat for every class the school runs.
3. Under **Add Section**, pick the class, type the section name (A, B, C) and click **Add Section**.
4. Switch to the **Subjects** tab and use **Add Subject** to add subjects per class.

To correct a class name: click **Rename** on that row, edit it, then press Enter or click **Save**. Escape cancels. The system will refuse two classes with the same name.

Step 4 · Fee structure

Sidebar › **Invoicing Hub** › **Fee Structure** `/fees/structure`

1. Choose the class.
2. Enter the monthly tuition fee and any other heads: admission fee, exam fee, transport.
3. Click **Save Fee Structure**.

Repeat for every class. Without this, monthly fee generation has nothing to work from.

Step 5 · Add your staff

See Part 2. Add the principal, accountant and teachers before admissions begin, so students can be assigned a class teacher.

Step 6 · Bring in past records (only if the school ran before IlmForge)

Old fee bills and payments, each student's previous balance, past salaries and past expenses come in from one Excel workbook, each filed on the date it really happened, so reports and every student's fee record are complete from the first day. See Past records in Part 5.

Part 2

Staff and teachers

Adding a teacher or other staff member

Sidebar › Staff Directory › Add Staff `/staff/new`

1. Fill in **Add New Staff Member**: name, father name, CNIC, phone, email, date of joining.
2. Click **Upload Photo** and attach a photograph. It is used on the staff ID card.
3. Enter the **Designation**, for example *Teacher*, *Accounts Officer* or *Security Guard*.
4. Choose the **Role**. This decides which portal the person gets and what they can see.
5. Click **Save Staff Member**.

ROLE	GETS	CAN SEE
Teacher	Teacher Portal	Their classes, attendance, marks
Accountant	Accountant Portal	Fee collection, vouchers, daily balance
Gatekeeper	Gate Portal	Gate entry, visitors, gate passes
Admin	Admin Dashboard	Everything

If you leave Role alone, the system chooses it from the designation. "Accounts Officer" becomes an accountant, "Security Guard" a gatekeeper, and anything else a teacher.

The login details: write them down immediately

As soon as the staff member is saved, a box appears with their sign-in details:

- **Portal link**: the web address to open
- **Login ID**: their email address, or their phone number if no email was given
- **Password**: a temporary password
- **Employee code**
- **Portal**: which portal they will land in

Each line has a **Copy** button, and **Copy all** copies the whole set at once.

IMPORTANT

The password is shown only once. Copy it and hand it over before closing the box. If it is lost, an admin must reset it from the Staff Directory. The staff member should change it after first sign-in.

You can look the portal link up again any time. See Part 8.

Editing or removing staff

Sidebar › Staff Directory `/staff`

Switch between **Table** and **Cards** view. Click a row to open and edit it. The Role cannot be changed here after creation, so ask an admin if someone's role must change.

The list shows **every** staff member (it used to stop at 25). Use the search box, or the department buttons above the list (*All*, *English*, *Science* … *No department*) to see one department. **Group by department** shows the list in department sections.

Departments

A teacher's department is chosen on the staff form (**Department**). If the one you need is not in the list, click **+ New** next to it, type the name and click **Add** : it is created and picked straight away. Choose **— No department —** to take someone out of their department.

Staff Directory › Manage departments `/staff/departments`

Lists the departments with how many staff work in each. Click **View / assign** on a department to see its staff:

- **Remove** takes one person out of the department.
- Tick people on the right (those with no department are listed first) and click **Add … to (department)** to move several at once.

Departments are also a filter on **Staff Attendance** (mark one department at a time) and on the **Staff Attendance Report** .

Part 3

Students and admissions

Admitting a new student

Sidebar › New Admission `/admissions/wizard`

The wizard has five steps shown across the top. You cannot move past a step with missing required fields; those are marked with a red asterisk.

1. **Student Info**: name, father name, B-Form/CNIC, date of birth, gender, address, mobile number. Use **Camera** to take the student's photo with a webcam, or Browse to upload one. The two optional panels at the bottom, *Previous Institutional History* and *Health & Emergency Information*, can be filled now or later.
2. **Class & Section**: pick the class and section, and the class teacher if asked.
3. **Fee Details**: the fee comes from the class fee structure. Apply a discount here if the school has agreed one, or mark the student as free.
4. **Parent Details**: parent name and **phone number**. The parent signs in with this number, so enter it correctly.
5. **Review & Admit**: check everything, then click **Complete Admission**.

After admission: two things to print

On the success screen:

- **Print Admission Form** prints the full A4 admission form on your school letterhead, already filled in, with signature lines for parent, class teacher, coordinator and principal. Print it, get it signed, and keep it in the student's file.
- **Print Credentials Slip** prints the student's and parent's portal sign-in details. Hand this to the parent.

IF YOU MISSED THEM

Both appear only on this screen. The admission form can be reprinted any time from **Admissions › Admission Form Print** `/admissions/form-print` by searching the student and choosing **Filled Form**.

Typed something wrong? Click **Correct a mistake in this admission** on the same screen, fix it, save, and then print.

Correcting an admission

Any detail entered at admission can be changed afterwards. Open **Edit** from the Student Registry, **Edit** or **Correct details** on the student's profile, or **Edit details** on Admission Form Print. The form has the same parts as the admission form:

TAB	WHAT YOU CAN CORRECT
Student	Name, last name, names in Urdu, gender, date of birth, B-Form, religion, caste, nationality, photo
Admission & class	Class, section, roll number, status, family number, admission date, admission test marks, free student
Father & mother	Names (also in Urdu), CNICs, qualifications, occupations, mother's mobile
Contact & address	Parent mobile, student email, parent's email and CNIC, province, city, postal and permanent address
Previous school	School, contact person, phone, admission number, last class, grade, address
Health	Blood group, food needs, allergies, medical condition

Each changed field says *changed* and the bottom of the form counts them. Only what you change is saved. If something is wrong (a CNIC with a digit missing, a date in the future), the form opens the tab with the problem and says what to fix; nothing is saved until it is right. The parent's email and CNIC belong to the parent account, so a change there also shows for brothers and sisters. The profile's **Personal Info** tab shows every detail that has been filled in.

Blank admission forms

Admissions › Admission Form Print, choose **Blank Form**, then **Print Blank Form**. Useful for walk-in enquiries and for keeping printed forms at the front desk.

A filled paper form came back: read it in instead of typing

When a parent returns the blank form filled in by hand, or sends a photo of it on WhatsApp, IlmForge can read it and fill the admission wizard for you.

1. **Admission Form Print** › **Filled form came back? Read it in**, or on the first step of **New Admission** click **Got a filled paper form back?**
2. Add the pages: **Choose photo / scan / PDF**, **Take a photo** (phone or tablet), drag the files onto the box, or press **Ctrl+V** to paste a copied picture. **Paste details as text** takes a message with the details. Photograph each page straight on, in good light.

3. Click **Read the form** (10 to 40 seconds).
4. Check the list of what was read. Correct any box, untick what you do not want. Boxes marked *check* were hard to read; anything that could not be read at all is listed to fill in by hand.
5. Click **Fill the admission form**. The wizard is filled in, class and section included, and a green note lists the fields to look at closely. Go through every step against the paper, add the photo, and click **Complete Admission** as usual.

Nothing is saved until you complete the admission. The pages are sent to an AI reading service to be read and are not stored by IlmForge.

NOT SWITCHED ON?

If the panel says *Reading paper forms is not switched on yet*, the server needs an AI key: whoever runs your IlmForge server sets `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` (Claude) or `GEMINI_API_KEY` (Google Gemini) in the server settings.

Finding and fixing student records

Sidebar › Student Registry `/students`

- Search by name, roll number or father name, or choose a class in **All classes** to list the whole class. **Active** / **Inactive** switches between current students and those who have left.
- The **Record** column says *Missing: photo, date of birth, …* for anything not filled in yet.
- **Edit** fixes any wrong or missing detail from the admission form (see Correcting an admission). Only what you change is saved. If the parent mobile changes, the parent signs in with the new number from then on, and IlmForge tells you so.
- **Delete** gives two choices. **Mark as left school** is for a student who has left: everything is kept, the student moves to Inactive and can still get a leaving or character certificate. **Delete record** is only for an entry made by mistake: unpaid bills are cancelled and the logins switched off, and it is refused once any fee has been paid.

Promotion moves a whole class up at session change.

Adding many students and staff from Excel

Sidebar › Import & Export `/settings/import-export`

Get the template first. Inside IlmForge, **Download template** on the Import & Export page gives you the workbook with your own classes already filled in. A blank copy is also here:

Download the Excel template .xlsx · blank

1. The workbook has four sheets: **Read me**, **Classes**, **Students** and **Staff**. Each sheet starts with a grey *Example* row, which is never imported.
2. Fill in one person per row. Leave **Roll No** and **Employee Code** blank and IlmForge creates them.
3. Click **Choose Excel file** and pick the filled workbook.
4. Read **Check before importing**. It lists every problem by sheet, row and column. Nothing is saved yet.
5. Click **Import**. A progress bar shows the import as it runs.
6. Click **Download login details** straight away. It lists every new username and password.
7. Underneath, **Imported students** lists everyone just added. Filter **Incomplete**, **No photo**, **No date of birth** or **No parent phone** and fix each one right there with **Edit** or the photo button, or delete a row added by mistake.

SHEET	COLUMNS (* REQUIRED)
Classes	Class*, Sections (e.g. `A, B`), Order
Students	Roll No (blank), Student Name*, Father Name*, Gender, Date of Birth, B-Form No, Class*, Section, Parent Phone, Parent Email, Mother Name, Address, Religion, Blood Group, Admission Date, Status
Staff	Employee Code (blank), Name*, Designation, Role, Phone or Email*, CNIC, Gender, Date of Birth, Department, Joining Date, Monthly Salary (Rs), Salary Type, Status (Active / Left)

GOOD TO KNOW

Dates are day first: **14/03/2014** is 14 March. Type phones as **03001234567**. Brothers and sisters with the same parent phone share one parent account. Importing the same file twice is safe: anyone already in the school is skipped.

PEOPLE WHO HAVE LEFT

Add students who have left with **Status = Inactive** and staff who have left with **Status = Left** when you will bring in their old fees or salaries (Past records). Staff marked Left get no login.

Moving a school to another server

1. On the old server: **Import & Export › Export records**. You get one Excel file in the same format as the template.
2. On the new server, signed in as admin: **Import & Export**, choose that file, check it, import it.

IMPORTANT

The file carries classes, students with their parents, and staff. Fee history, attendance and exam marks are not in it: use **Settings › Backup & Restore** to move the whole database.

Adding or changing a photo

WHERE	HOW
Student Registry	Click the photo (or the empty photo box) on the student's row
Student profile	**Add photo** / **Change photo**
ID Cards	A card without a photo says **No photo · Add photo**; **Show only these** lists them all
Certificates	The photo button next to the student's name
Admission Form Print	The photo button on the filled form, next to **Edit details**
Online admission form	Parents attach it when applying; it comes across when you admit the application
Staff	Staff Directory › **Edit** › the **Add Photo** box, or the photo spot on their ID card row

Pick a picture from the computer or phone: **JPG, PNG or WEBP, up to 5 MB**. It is shrunk automatically to about 40 KB, so large phone photos are fine. The same photo then appears on the ID card, the character and leaving certificates, the admission form and the portal.

SAVED ONLY ON THIS COMPUTER?

Photos added before this update may live only in one browser. Where you see that message, click **Save to records** (ID Cards) or **save it to the record** (student profile) so every computer sees it.

Online admissions: your school's own admission form

Every school on IlmForge has its own **web name** and its own pages. For Future Foundation School, for example:

PAGE	LINK	WHO USES IT
School page	`…/s/future-foundation-school`	Anyone: one link for everything
Admission form	`…/s/future-foundation-school/apply`	Parents applying for admission
Fee slip	`…/s/future-foundation-school/fees`	Parents printing a voucher by roll number

Each page shows **your** school's name, logo and colours, lists **your** classes and campuses, and sends everything to **your** school only.

Sidebar › **Portal Links** › **Share with families** `/settings/portal-links`

Each link has **Copy**, **Open** and **QR code**. The admission form's QR panel also has **Print "Admissions open" poster**: an A4 poster with your logo, name, QR code and phone number.

When a parent applies (they can attach the child's photo: JPG, PNG or WEBP up to 5 MB), they get a reference number such as **ADM-00042**, and the school is told at once:

1. The **bell** at the top of every admin page shows a red count. Open it to see *New admission application · Online form*.
2. The dashboard's **Needs attention** list shows applications waiting for a call back.
3. An email goes to the school's registered email address (when email is set up).
4. If IlmForge is open, a short message pops up within a minute.

Admissions › **Admission Inquiries** `/admissions/inquiries`

- New applications are under **New**; the arrow shows everything the parent wrote.
- Call or WhatsApp the parent with one click, then set **Contacted**, **Admitted** or **Closed**.
- **Admit** opens the admission wizard with the details, the class and the photo already filled in. The inquiry is marked Admitted by itself afterwards.
- Walk-in and phone enquiries: **Add inquiry**, so every enquiry is in one list.

CHANGING YOUR WEB NAME

Portal Links › **Change web name** lets you shorten it (e.g. `future-foundation`). Links already shared with the old name, including printed QR codes, stop working, so share the new ones.

Part 4

Attendance

Marking daily student attendance

Sidebar › Attendance Tracker › Student Attendance `/attendance-hub`

1. Select class, section and the date. Today is selected by default.
2. Click **Start Marking →**.
3. Mark each student present, absent or leave.
4. Click **Save & Notify**.

Save & Notify saves the register *and* sends absence messages to the parents of absent students. To save without messaging, check the school's notification settings first or ask your admin.

The attendance hub shows **Attendance Not Marked**, so you can see at a glance which classes still need doing today.

Staff attendance

Attendance Tracker › Staff Attendance › Mark Attendance `/attendance/staff`

To mark one department at a time, choose it in the **All departments** box first; **Mark All** then applies only to that department.

Other attendance methods

METHOD	WHERE	STATUS
ID card scan (QR / barcode)	`/attendance/barcode`	Works: handheld scanner or camera
Photo check-in	`/attendance/face-attendance`	Works; a person taps the photo. It does not recognise faces
Fingerprint machine	`/attendance/biometric-attendance`	A physical machine cannot send punches in yet
Spreadsheet import (CSV)	`/attendance/excel`	Works: columns `date`, `rollNo`, `status`
Period-wise, per subject	`/attendance/period`	Works

Whatever the method, a student has **one** attendance record per day. A scan marks a student present only if nobody has marked them yet, so it never overwrites a teacher's *Leave* or *Absent*.

Setting up ID card scanning at the gate

Every student ID card carries a QR code and a barcode of the student's roll number. Scanning either one marks the student present.

Handheld scanner (recommended for a busy gate)

1. Buy any USB or Bluetooth *1D/2D* barcode scanner that reads QR and Code 39 (about Rs 4,000–9,000). It works as a keyboard; no driver is needed.
2. Plug it into the gate computer. Test in Notepad: scanning a card should type the roll number and move to a new line. If it doesn't, scan the *Enter / CR suffix* code in the scanner's booklet.
3. Sign in to IlmForge and open **Attendance › Barcode scan**. Click once in the scan box.
4. Scan cards. Each scan shows the student's name and photo. Scanning the same card twice is ignored.

Webcam or laptop camera

1. Any USB webcam (720p) or laptop camera, in good light.
2. Same screen, click **Start Camera** and allow camera access.
3. Hold the card 15–25 cm from the camera. It is read automatically.

BROWSER

Use Chrome or Edge on the `https://` address. Staff cards are not read by this screen; mark staff on Staff Attendance.

Photo check-in and fingerprint machines

Attendance Tracker › Photo Check-in shows a class's photos; the person on duty taps a photo to mark that student present. It needs no camera and does not recognise faces by itself.

FINGERPRINT MACHINES

A ZKTeco, eSSL or similar machine **cannot yet send its punches to IlmForge**. Don't buy one for this. If you already have one, copy its daily log into a sheet with the columns `date` (YYYY-MM-DD), `rollNo` and `status`, save it as CSV and load it on Attendance › Excel import. For daily use, ID card scanning is far less work.

Correcting a mistake

Attendance › **Corrections** `/attendance/corrections`

Use this to change a register after it has been saved. Corrections are recorded, so there is a trail of who changed what.

Part 5

Fees

Generating monthly fees

Sidebar › Invoicing Hub › Generate Monthly Fee `/fees/generate`

1. Choose the month and year.
2. Click **Generate Fee for [month]**.

This creates one invoice per active student from the fee structure. Run it once a month. There are also **Generate Custom Fee** for one-off charges and **Generate Transport Fee**.

A student who already has that month's fee is skipped, including months brought in from Past records, so running it twice never bills anyone twice. An admission or transport fee in the same month does not stop the monthly fee.

Collecting a fee

Sidebar › Collect Fee `/fees/collect`

1. Type at least 2 characters of the student's name, roll number or father name.
2. Click the student in the results.
3. Their invoices appear. Click **Collect** on the one being paid.
4. Enter the amount, any discount, and the payment method.
5. **Payment date** is today. If the money was received on an earlier day, choose that day: the payment is filed on that date in every report. The message to the parent switches to **Do not notify**; change it back if they should be told.
6. Click **Confirm Payment**.

A receipt appears, with the payment date, for you to print and hand to the parent. The parent is also notified automatically if messaging is set up.

NOTE

The system will not let you collect more than the amount outstanding on an invoice. If you try, it tells you the actual amount due.

Correcting a wrong amount

IMPORTANT

If the wrong amount was entered, **do not delete anything**. Scroll to the **Payments Received** panel under the student's invoices.

- **Correct**: enter the right amount and a reason. The original entry stays on record, marked *Corrected*, and a new receipt is issued.
- **Void**: cancel the payment entirely, with a reason, for example a bounced cheque.

A reason is required for both. The original is never deleted. This is deliberate, so the school always has a true record of what was collected and what was changed. Collection totals, reports and the dashboard update to the corrected figure immediately.

Following up defaulters

Invoicing Hub › **Fee Defaulters** `/fees/defaulters`

Lists students with outstanding fees and lets you send reminders. Each student's parent gets **one** message with the total still due and the months it covers.

Other fee screens

TASK	WHERE
Edit or delete an invoice	`/fees/invoices`
Family voucher, siblings on one voucher	`/fees/family-voucher`
Discounted students	`/fees/discounted`
Annual fee increase	`/fees/increment`
Collection report: payments received in a month, with the day each was entered	`/fees/collection-report`

Past records: fees, salaries and expenses from before IlmForge

Sidebar › **Past Records** `/settings/past-records`

A school that has been running for years can bring its history in, so the dashboard, the reports, each student's fee record and the payroll are complete from the first day. Admin only.

FIRST

Add every student and staff member with Import & Export, including those who have left: students with **Status = Inactive**, staff with **Status = Left**. Past records find them by roll number and employee code.

1. Click **Download template**. The workbook has four sheets, plus lists of your students and staff to copy roll numbers and employee codes from.
2. Fill in only the sheets you need (table below).
3. Click **Choose Excel file**. **Check before importing** lists every problem by sheet, row and column, and the rupee totals (billed, received, owed, salaries paid, spent) to compare with your old registers. Nothing is saved yet.
4. Click **Import [n] rows**.

SHEET	ONE ROW PER	COLUMNS (* REQUIRED)
Fee History	student per month	Roll No*, Student Name, Fee Month* (07/2025), Fee Title (blank = Monthly Fee), Fee Amount (Rs)*, Concession (Rs), Late Fine (Rs), Paid (Rs), Paid On, Method, Receipt No, Remarks
Previous Balance	student	Roll No*, Student Name, Balance Due (Rs)*, As Of (date), Remarks
Salary History	staff member per month	Employee Code (or CNIC or Phone), Name, Salary Month*, Basic Salary (Rs)*, Allowances, Bonus, Absent / Late / Loan Deduction (Rs), Net Salary (Rs) as a check, Status (Paid / Unpaid), Paid On, Remarks
Expenses	expense	Date*, Category*, Amount (Rs)*, Description, Paid To

- Every row is filed on its own date: a fee paid on 8 July 2025 counts in July 2025 in every report. A row with no **Paid On** date counts on the 10th of its fee month (salaries: the last day of the month).
- **Previous Balance** becomes one unpaid bill per student, *Previous Balance (Arrears)*, collected in Fee Collection like any other bill. Use **either** Fee History **or** Previous Balance for the same months, not both, or the dues are counted twice.
- Anything left unpaid is a real due: parents see it on their portal, and it appears in Fee Defaulters and fee reminders. Enter an amount the school has written off as **Concession**.
- A paid salary is also recorded under **Expenses › Salaries** on its paid-on day. Do not list it again on the Expenses sheet.
- No message is sent to parents or staff, and old fees are not counted as any accountant's cash on the daily balance sheet.

- A month already in IlmForge is skipped, so importing the same file twice adds nothing. A bill generated in IlmForge but paid by hand gets that payment added to it.
- Months are written **07/2025** (Jul 2025 also works); dates day first, **08/07/2025**; amounts in rupees.

UNDO

Earlier imports at the bottom of the page lists each import and what is still in IlmForge from it. **Undo** removes all of it after you confirm. It is refused once a fee has been collected or a salary paid in IlmForge against something from that import, so those receipts stay correct.

ONLY A FEW ENTRIES?

Enter them directly with their real date: **Payment date** in Fee Collection, **Paid on** in Payroll Manager, **Date** in Expense Tracker.

Part 6

Exams and results

Setting up exam rules (once)

School Settings › Exam Settings `/settings/exam-settings`

Set **Pass / Fail Criteria**, **Grade Boundaries (%)**, **Division Thresholds (%)** and **Admit Card Instructions**. Click **Save Exam Settings**.

Exams › Result Configuration `/exams/result-config`

- **Grade Configuration**: **Add Grade** for each grade band (A+, A, B ...)
- **Signatories**: **Add Signatory** for the names printed on result cards
- **Final Remarks**: **Add Remark** for the comments teachers can choose

Click **Save Preferences**.

How many terms your school runs

School Settings › Exam Settings › Exam Terms

Choose how many exam terms your school holds in a session, from 1 to 6. Most schools run two. The Exam Vault then shows one tab per term: *1st Term*, *2nd Term*, and so on up to *6th Term*.

Set this before creating exams, so each exam can be filed under the right term.

> **NOTE**
> Lowering the number later does not delete exams already recorded under a removed term. They stay in the system and reappear if you raise the count again.

Creating an exam

Sidebar › Exam Vault `/exams`

1. Click **Add Exam**.
2. Enter the exam name (Mid Term, Final Term), class, and dates.
3. Choose the **Term**. The dropdown lists the terms your school has set up.
4. Save.

Entering marks

From the exam row, click **Marks**. Enter marks per student per subject and save. Teachers can do this for their own classes from the Teacher Portal.

Results and printing

OUTPUT	WHERE
Result cards	`/exams/:id/results`
Admit cards / exam slips	`/exams/exam-slip`
Gazette sheet	`/exams/gazette`
Merit list	`/exams/merit-list`
Annual report card	`/exams/annual-report`
Subject analysis	`/exams/subject-analysis`
Exam timetable	`/exams/timetable`
Question papers	`/exams/question-papers`

Part 7

ID cards

Sidebar › Student Registry › ID Cards `/id-cards`

1. Choose **Students** or **Staff** at the top.
2. Filter by class and section if needed.
3. Tick the people you want cards for, or tick the box in the header row to select all.
4. Choose a design from the five below.
5. Set the **Primary** and **Accent** colours to match your school.
6. Add a photo for anyone missing one, using the small camera button on their row.
7. Click **Print [n] Cards**. The button shows how many you selected, for example *Print 12 Cards*. A preview window opens; click **Print ID Cards** in it to send to the printer.

DESIGN	SHAPE	LOOK
Academic	Portrait	Curved header, round photo
Campus Arc	Portrait	Sweeping arcs
Executive	Landscape	Photo left, QR panel on the back
Minimal	Landscape	Clean, plain
Bold Band	Portrait	Strong colour band, large QR

Every card prints front and back together, with a scannable QR code on **both** sides and a barcode of the ID. Fields with no value are left off the card rather than printed as a dash.

PRINTING TIP

Print on card stock if you have it. The cards are standard CR80 size, the same as a bank card, so they fit normal ID card holders and lanyards.

Part 8

Portals for parents, students and teachers

Everyone at the school gets their own portal, branded with your school's name and logo.

Where to find the links

Sidebar › **Portal Links** `/settings/portal-links`

The top of this page has your public links (school page, admission form, fee slip; see Online admissions). Below them is the sign-in link for every role, with what each person signs in with:

PORTAL	SIGNS IN WITH
Admin Dashboard	Email
Teacher Portal	Email
Accountant Portal	Email
Gate Portal	Email
Student Portal	Roll number
Parent Portal	Phone number

Use **Copy** on any row, or **Copy all** to send the whole set. **Open** previews the sign-in page as that person will see it.

SAFE TO SHARE

A link only opens the sign-in page. It is not a password. What someone can see is decided by their own account, so a parent opening the Admin link still only reaches the Parent Portal.

Giving a parent access

Parent accounts are created automatically during admission. The parent signs in with the **phone number** entered in step 4 of the admission wizard. Their password is on the credentials slip printed at admission.

A common problem is a phone number typed wrongly at admission. Correct it on the student record and the parent can then sign in.

Giving a teacher access

Created automatically when you add the staff member. The details appear on screen once; see Part 2. The link is always available from Portal Links.

Part 9

HR, payroll and leaves

Sidebar › HR Central `/human-resource`

One screen with tabs: **Staff** **Payroll** **Attendance** **Appraisals** **Leaves** **Loans**

Running payroll

Sidebar › Payroll Manager `/payroll`

1. Choose the month and year at the top (it opens on the current month).
2. Click **Generate Payroll**. Staff who joined after that month are left out of it.
3. Review each staff member's salary, allowances and deductions. **Edit** changes a month that is not paid yet; a paid month cannot be changed.
4. Set **Paid on** to the day the salaries were paid (today, unless it was earlier), then **Pay** one person or **Pay all**.
5. Print salary slips.

Each paid salary is also recorded under **Expenses › Salaries** on its paid-on day, so the dashboard's spending and the profit and loss include it. A month cannot be paid twice.

Recording expenses

Sidebar › Expense Tracker `/expenses`

Add an expense with its **date** (today unless it was spent earlier), category, amount and a description. The list shows one month at a time with its total; choose another month, or **All**, at the top. A wrong entry can be edited or deleted.

Other HR screens

TASK	WHERE
Leave applications and balances	`/leaves` · `/attendance/leave-balance`
Staff loans and advances	`/salary/loans`
Appraisals	`/staff/appraisals`
Departments	`/staff/departments`
Staff birthdays	`/staff/birthdays`
CV bank	`/staff/cv-bank`

Part 10

Reports and printing

Sidebar › Insights Hub `/reports-hub`

The starting point for reports. Commonly used:

REPORT	WHERE
Fee collection report	`/fees/collection-report`
Attendance report	`/attendance/report`
Staff attendance report	`/attendance/staff-report`
Daily balance sheet	`/accounting/balancesheet`
Accounts ledger	`/accounts`
Defaulters	`/fees/defaulters`

Daily balance sheet

Accounts Ledger › Daily Balance Sheet `/accounting/balancesheet`

Each accountant's cash in hand: what they collected since they last handed cash over, less what they spent.

- Cash is counted by when a payment was **entered**. A payment entered today but dated an earlier day is counted today (the cash is still in hand) and is marked with the date written on it.
- Old records brought in from Past records are shown apart: they are nobody's cash.
- **Settle** records that the cash was handed over; the sheet then starts again from zero.

Printing anything

Click the **Print** button on any page. Only the document prints; the sidebar, menus, search boxes and buttons are left off the paper. Table headings repeat at the top of each page in multi-page reports.

To save as PDF instead, choose **Save as PDF** as the destination in your browser's print dialog.

Certificates

Sidebar › Certificates `/certificates`

Student Certificates and **Staff Certificates** tabs, including school leaving, character and bonafide certificates. `/certificates/registry` keeps a record of everything issued.

Part 11

The dashboard

Sidebar › Smart Dashboard

The banner and the Today cards

The blue banner has **Mark attendance**, **Collect fee**, **Admission** and **Export PDF**. The figures refresh by themselves every two minutes.

Below it, three cards: student attendance (teal), staff attendance (blue) and fee collected today (purple). A **TO DO** badge means some people are still not marked. Click a card to go and finish it.

Needs attention

Appears only when something is outstanding: students not yet marked, unpaid invoices, or invoices that show **more paid than billed**, usually an amount typed in the wrong unit. Each line links to where you fix it. When nothing is outstanding it says *All clear*.

Quick actions

Twelve large shortcuts to the daily jobs: Mark attendance, Collect fee, Exam Vault, New admission, Scan ID cards, Generate fee, Defaulters and more. Click **Customise** and tap shortcuts to add or remove them (up to 12), then **Done**. **Reset** brings back the standard set. Your choice is remembered on that computer for your login.

School health

A score out of 100 with the reasons underneath it. Each line shows what was measured against its target, so you can see which one is pulling the score down. Anything not yet recorded is left out rather than counted as zero, and the panel says how much of the picture it had.

The number row

Students, staff, collected today, collected this month, outstanding, unpaid invoices. Click any of them to go straight to the list behind it.

Revenue and expenses

Collected against spent for the last 12 months.

Why this result?

Explains the change from one month to the next: how much came from student numbers, from fee changes, from collection rate, and from each expense category. The figures always add up exactly to the total change.

Forecast

Appears once the school has six months of fee and expense history.

ON A NEW SCHOOL

Some panels say *"N more months of data needed"*. This is normal. They switch on by themselves once there is enough history to be accurate.

Fee income forecast

Once fee income has been recorded in three different months, a dashed trend line projects the next three months and says whether income is moving up or down. A guide, not a promise.

Export PDF in the blue banner produces a clean copy for board meetings.

Part 12

Who can do what

Train each person on only the parts they need. The *Training for* buttons at the top of this page use this table.

ROLE	CAN DO	TRAIN ON PARTS
Admin / Principal	Everything, including Import & Export and Past Records	All
Accountant	Fees, vouchers, defaulters, daily balance, expenses	5, 10
Teacher	Attendance and marks for their own classes	4, 6
Gatekeeper	Gate entry, visitors, gate passes	—
Parent	Their own children only: fees, attendance, results	8
Student	Their own record only	8

Roles are enforced by the system. A teacher who opens an admin address is turned away rather than shown the page.

Part 13

When something goes wrong

Working without internet

WITHOUT INTERNET	WHAT HAPPENS
Opening IlmForge	Opens as normal on a computer or phone that has used it before.
Pages opened earlier	Show the data they had when you last saw them.
Marking attendance	**Saved on this device** and sent automatically when the internet is back (class register, Mark Now, teacher portal, staff attendance).
Everything else	Needs the internet. You are told "You are offline" and the form stays filled in; save again when the connection is back.

A dark bar at the bottom says **You're offline** and how many attendance saves are waiting. When the connection returns it says **Back online** and sends them by itself; an amber bar with **Send now** shows if any are still waiting.

IMPORTANT

Keep the device signed in until waiting attendance has been sent. Fee payments are never saved offline: a receipt only exists once the server has confirmed the payment.

A weak signal no longer signs anyone out. Signing out removes this device's saved copies of your data, so the next person on a shared office computer cannot see them.

"The server could not complete that request"

The system could not reach the server. Check the internet connection and try again. If it continues, contact your IT support. Nothing you did caused it, and no data was lost.

A page shows no records, but you know there are some

Clear any search box and filters at the top of the page. If a red message appeared, the server is unreachable; the data is not missing.

A parent cannot sign in

They must use the **phone number** recorded at admission, not an email. Check the number on the student record is correct and complete.

A student cannot sign in

Students sign in with their **roll number**, not an email.

The wrong fee amount was collected

Do not delete it. Use **Correct** or **Void** in the Payments Received panel. See Part 5.

A fee, salary or expense happened on an earlier day

Enter it with that date: **Payment date** in Fee Collection, **Paid on** in Payroll Manager, **Date** in Expense Tracker. It is filed on that date in every report.

A past-records file was imported by mistake

Past Records › **Earlier imports** › **Undo** removes everything that import added. If it is refused, fees were collected or salaries paid against it since; the message names them.

A student's details are wrong or missing

Student Registry › find the student › **Edit**. See Part 3.

A class name is spelled wrong

School Settings › Classes › **Rename** on that row.

Printing includes the menus and buttons

Only the document should print. If menus appear, your browser may be printing an old copy of the page. Reload it and print again.

The password was lost before it was written down

An admin must reset it from the Staff Directory. Passwords cannot be recovered, only reset.

Quick reference

Daily routine

WHEN	WHO	TASK
Every morning	Class teachers	Mark attendance, **Save & Notify**
Every morning	Office	Check Attendance Not Marked, chase missing classes
Through the day	Accountant	Collect fees, print receipts
End of day	Accountant	Daily balance sheet
Start of month	Office	Generate Monthly Fee
Through the month	Office	Follow up defaulters
End of month	Admin	Payroll, review dashboard
Exam time	Teachers	Enter marks
Exam time	Office	Print admit cards, then result cards

IlmForge staff user manual · Updated October 2026 · Covers fee corrections, per-role portal links, admission form printing, ID card designs, class rename, configurable exam terms and the new dashboard.